

August 20, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Keitha Turner (MRN MUSC5870574), Claim MUSC-6CD1-4

Patient	Keitha Turner (DOB 2004-07-22)
MRN	MUSC5870574
Member ID / Group	AMB999437436 / GRP-60820
Claim number	MUSC-6CD1-4
Date of service	2026-04-25
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$508.21
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2026-09-01

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal appeal on behalf of patient Keitha Turner (MRN: MUSC5870574, Member ID: AMB999437436) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-6CD1-4 for services rendered on April 25, 2026, by James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465). The claim was submitted on May 5, 2026, and denied on June 3, 2026, under CARC 197 ("Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent") and RARC N54 ("Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services"), with the payer remark stating: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully contests this denial and requests full reprocessing and payment of the allowed amount of \$368.21.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turner is a 22-year-old established patient who presented on April 25, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility, for an office visit with Dr. Ferrell. The encounter was coded as CPT 99214, representing an outpatient visit of moderate complexity for an established patient, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified). The visit was appropriately billed under revenue code 0510 at a place of service 22. Ms. Turner carries a documented history of recurrent acute viral pharyngitis, active prescriptions including an epinephrine auto-injector and fexofenadine consistent with a known allergy profile, and a prior course of subcutaneous immunotherapy, reflecting an ongoing relationship with this practice and a legitimate clinical basis for the established-patient visit in question.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of this claim on prior authorization grounds is not consistent with standard coverage obligations for the service billed. CPT 99214 is a routine evaluation and management service for an established outpatient patient. Evaluation and management services of this nature — particularly those addressing an acute, time-sensitive condition such as an upper respiratory infection — are widely recognized as services that do not require prior authorization under most commercial and Marketplace plan benefit structures, including those governed by applicable state and federal regulations. Requiring prospective authorization for an acute, unscheduled office visit for an established patient would create a barrier to medically necessary care that is inconsistent with both sound clinical practice and regulatory expectations for Marketplace plans operating under the Affordable Care Act.

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care review its prior authorization requirements as applied to this specific CPT code and place of service combination. If the plan maintains that authorization was required, we request that the payer provide, in writing, the specific benefit provision or authorization requirement that applies to CPT 99214 at place of service 22 for an established patient presenting with an acute diagnosis. In the absence of a clearly documented and member-accessible authorization requirement for this service type, denial under CARC 197 and RARC N54 is not supportable.

Furthermore, the billed amount of \$508.21 with an allowed amount of \$368.21 indicates that the payer has already adjudicated the contractual rate, suggesting the claim was otherwise clean and payable but for the authorization flag. This supports the position that no substantive clinical or coding deficiency exists in the claim.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-6CD1-4, reprocess the claim in full, and remit payment of the allowed amount of \$368.21 to MUSC Health Florence Medical Center. Should the payer require additional documentation to support this appeal, including the medical record for the April 25, 2026 encounter, we are prepared to submit those records promptly through the secure provider portal. We ask that this reconsideration be completed within the timeframe required under applicable prompt-pay and appeal-rights obligations, and no later than the appeal deadline of September 1, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)

- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record